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As his theory goes, by the time some hot investing trend has made its way to the editors of *Time* magazine, it's all over but the crying.

There are lots of examples of how often this was true. In 2005, *Time* gave top billing to housing. Home prices soon topped and what came next was the worst recession since the Great Depression, led by a 32% crash in home prices.

Time named Amazon.com chief Jeff Bezos as Person of the Year in December 1999; that was weeks from the top of the dotcom bubble (Q1 2000). And *Time*'s editors did not do Mark Zuckerberg and Facebook shareholders any favors by bestowing the same honorific on him in 2010. Soon after, its IPO was a flop, and the stock did not recover until the firm finally figured out mobile, years later.

Before you start selling shares of companies that end up on covers, you should know that the indicator isn't applicable to individual firms. Apple is a favorite example—it's been on 100s of magazine covers since 1981. If you used any of those as a sell signal, you left a lot of money on the table...

That is the problem with magazine covers—or TikToks, tweets, YouTube videos, online news, TV segments, or whatever you are using to track